

rec'd 1/05/02

2001-135

CFO-RC FILE #: _____ RESULTS: _____ OBSERVER: Coen Dexter
COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS SIGHT RECORD FORM

Species: Whimbrel (Common Name) Numenius phaeopus (Scientific Name)

(A)

Date(s) of observation: 2 June 2001 Number of birds seen: 1

Sex: ? Plumage: worn adult

Exact location: Confluence Park

County: Delta Near by town: Delta Elevation: 4900'

Length of observation: 30 min Times(s) of observation: 5:00 PM

Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: Brenda Wright

Other observers who independently saw the bird(s): ?

Light conditions (quality; direction relative to bird's position): Good light - sun behind us

Optical equipment used: 10 X 40 Swarovski and 45 power Nikon Scope

Distance from bird(s): 150' to 200'

Was bird photographed? No Were photos submitted? —

Who took the photographs? —

Describe the general and specific habitat in which the bird(s) occurred: Confluence Park (Lake)
was drained and the Whimbrel was feeding with
American Avocets.

Describe the bird's behavior (flying; feeding; habits; behaviors used in identifying the species or in supporting the identification): The large shore bird with a
long decurved bill was probing in mud. The bird did
not fly or call.

Describe the bird(s) in detail. This is the most important part of this report. Include overall size and shape, and how you placed the bird(s) in the general group that you did. Give complete details of plumage, including head, throat, undersides, nape, back, wings, and tail. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird. Describe other details, such as color and shape of bill, legs, eye, (etc.) that were important in making the identification.

The bird was nearly the same size as the A. Avocets.

The shore bird was probing in the mud for food with a long decurved
bill. The bill was dark and heavy at the base. The head had a
very noticeable pale median crown-stripe. The bird was grayish-
brown overall and the flanks showed barring. The legs were gray.
The area above the eye (eye stripe) was light brown vs the crown
which was dark brown except for the pale median crown giving the bird a
very striped head pattern,

Describe bird's call: None

Discuss similar species and how you eliminated them: Bristle-thighed Curlew have

weakly marked flanks. Long-billed Curlew has plain crown, very long bill, and all

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? I have never seen

a Bristle-thighed Curlew but know the Long-billed Curlew very well.

List books, guides, recordings, or other sources consulted and how these influenced your

identification: Sibley's and National Geographic field guides

confirmed but did not influence my identification.

This report was made from notes made during X or after — observation, or later

from memory X. Date of written report: 26 Nov 01 Signature: Coen Dexter

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